

Amendment No. 1 to HB2143

Crawford
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2483

House Bill No. 2143*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 58, Chapter 3, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) The department of veterans services shall conduct a study within the existing resources of the department that includes:

(1) An evaluation of county veterans service office resources, including:

- (A) Current county veterans service officer (CVSO) staffing levels;
- (B) Accreditation status of office personnel;
- (C) The hours of operation of such offices; and
- (D) CVSO office budget levels and funding sources;

(2) The identification of underserved areas, including:

- (A) An analysis of veteran population by county;
- (B) A comparison of veteran population numbers based on accredited CVSOs; and

(C) The identification of counties or regions without a full-time CVSO;

(3) Operational capacity, including a review and compilation of county-level workload productivity metrics;

(4) Local outreach efforts, community outreach events, partnerships, and other entities providing, or sources of, assistance for veterans at the local level; and

(5) The identification of potential funding mechanisms to support local veterans service offices.

(b) The department shall compile a report of the study conducted pursuant to subsection (a) and submit the report to the governor and the speakers of the senate and house of representatives no later than December 31, 2026.

(c) This section is deleted on January 1, 2027.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.